المجلس من أجل القرى البدوية غير المعترف بها
המועצה למען הכפרים הבדואיים הלא מוכרים
The Council for the Unrecognized Bedouin Villages

The Regional Councils Plan – Position Paper

From Survival to Prosperity: An Economic Plan for Regularizing the Unrecognized Villages in the Negev

October 2026

1. In Brief

The problem. Some 150,000 citizens in about 30,000 families live in Bedouin villages in the Negev without recognition, without infrastructure and without prospects. "Regularization" by way of eviction, concentration and urbanization began more than 50 years ago – and failed. Since then the population of the villages has grown sixfold, and it continues to grow by about 4,000 a year.

The root of the problem. A 56-fold gap in the allocation of land for rural settlement. In the five Jewish regional councils of the northern Negev, some 70,000 residents live on 1.9 million dunams. Alongside them live some 150,000 rural Bedouin, yet the Bedouin regional councils have been allotted only 71,000 dunams. One-third of the rural population holds about 96% of the land; two-thirds hold about 4%.

Rural residents, northern Negev	Residents	Regional council area (dunams)	Dunams per capita
Jews	~70,000	~1.9 million (Eshkol, Sha'ar HaNegev, Sdot Negev, Merhavim, Bnei Shimon)	28
Bedouin	~150,000	~71,000 (Neve Midbar, Al-Kasom)	0.5

The price. Tens of billions of shekels in lost output every year, and heavy social damage, from which the "governability" discourse has grown.

> **The solution we ask of the government**

- Abandon the policy of concentration and urbanization and recognize the villages where they stand, on the moshav model, as the Goldberg Committee recommended (2008);
- Stop the demolitions and freeze the measures that contradict regularization;
- Expand the Bedouin councils to about 600,000 dunams, so that they include 39 of the 46 Bedouin villages;
- Allocate 30,000 residential plots of 2 dunams, enough for two generations ahead through densification;
- Allocate 30,000 smallholdings of 3 dunams, so that recognition comes with an economic leap from thousands of new businesses, adding billions to the Negev's output every year;
- Commission a study to measure and map the economic and social benefits of full implementation of the plan;
- Set clear rules for the interim period (the "Life Now" program) until building with permits becomes possible;
- Begin implementation immediately in villages that already have ready plans.

What the state gains from full implementation. A preliminary estimate, to be tested in the socio-economic study: additional output of 20–30 billion shekels a year in the Negev, many more women and young people in work, better education, less crime, a shift from welfare payments to taxes, integration and civic belonging.

The outcome: a Negev that is more prosperous and safer for all its residents, Jews and Arabs alike.

The **Implementation Annex** at the end of this document sets out the plan's stages, timelines, responsible bodies and the list of villages.

2. Demolition Without a Solution or a Vision

According to Bedouin Authority data, in the six years up to 2022 the state demolished about 600 homes a year and moved only 33 families a year, on average, onto regularized plots. The pace of regularization has not changed since, but the number of home demolitions has grown to about 800 a year.

At the current pace it would take 900 years to regularize the 30,000 rural families – not counting some 1,200 newly married couples and some 4,000 babies born each year.

What these figures mean is that there is no real "regularization". It is an empty slogan. Judged by results, the Bedouin Authority is failing in its mission.

3. No Solution in the Towns Either

The Bedouin Authority's failure is not limited to the villages. As the body in charge of planning and development in Rahat and the towns, it is responsible for a cumulative

shortage of tens of thousands of housing units – about 8,500 in Rahat, about 4,000 in Kseifa, and so on. Nearly a thousand people competed for 18 new plots it marketed in Ar'ara this summer.

The failure is evident everywhere: in the villages, where new homes are demolished, and in the towns, where the pace of development falls far short of the need. According to a survey by Prof. Nuzha Allassad Alhuzail, about 93% of young Bedouin up to age 30 live with their parents. This creates an unhealthy pressure cooker.

4. From Coercion to Consent

First and foremost, the failure of regularization stems from the state's refusal to narrow the huge gap in land allocation for rural settlement. Village residents are attached to their land and determined to fight for their way of life. The policy of "enforcement in support of regularization" has not delivered the expected results either, despite the severe harm it has caused. Escalating forceful confrontation brings only chaos, not a solution.

Had the rural Bedouin been Jews, the state would long ago have turned them into moshav members. That is the way of life that suits them best: a homestead where the extended family lives together, space for herds and livelihood, and land for farming. After all, in the first half of the 20th century the Bedouin of the northern Negev cultivated more than 2 million dunams. This is exactly what the plan seeks, with one important change: the economic land will not be agricultural only.

The strength of the "Regional Councils Plan" lies in the full consensus it enjoys among village leaderships. It replaces enforcement resources and court time with consent and cooperation, which will make it possible to stop the damage and complete implementation.

5. The Cost of the Current Situation

Non-recognition is not a status quo. It is a budgetary sinkhole for the state and a reality that impoverishes citizens:

Demolitions. Their cost to the state is estimated at hundreds of millions of shekels a year. For residents – reckoning about 100,000 shekels per home, plus further losses from the destruction of other property and the loss of regularization grants – the costs over the past four years probably total 300–500 million shekels. This is a heavy blow to an economically weak population. Impoverishment does not bring governability; it brings bitterness, anger and despair, along with harm to health and economic productivity. That is bad for everyone.

Crime. Poverty predicts high crime, and property crime and other kinds of crime carry heavy economic costs. At the same time, violent-crime data point to the failure of urbanization and to the importance of preserving the villages: of the 35 Negev Bedouin murdered in 2025, 32 lived in Rahat and the six local councils. Three lived in villages that were recognized but whose regularization has been fraught with difficulty because of the same flawed policy. Not one of the victims lived in an unrecognized village.

Women and children. The employment rate of Bedouin women stands at about 25%, compared with almost 80% among Jewish women. About 3,200 children of compulsory-education age are not enrolled in any framework, and in the villages themselves there are kindergarten places for only about 5% of the children (Division for the Socio-Economic Development of Bedouin Society, 2025). Research shows that every dollar invested in early childhood returns about 10 dollars to society.

According to a preliminary estimate, the state loses tens of billions of shekels in output every year as the status quo continues. The precise figure needs to be measured, which is why the plan calls for an in-depth economic study, whose components are set out in the Implementation Annex.

6. Economic Development Is the Key, With an Emphasis on Small Businesses

Regularizing the unrecognized villages on a rural model is not a punishment for the state but an opportunity. Its interest in prosperity and a good life in the Negev aligns with that of the residents.

More than 90% of businesses in Israel are small and micro businesses (CBS, 2024). The natural way to encourage economic activity and employment in the villages is therefore to allow such businesses to be set up there – and that requires space. Hence the plan's guiding idea: land as a means of production, not just a plot for a house.

A family with a smallholding can start a business or lease out the land, support itself and pay taxes. A Princeton University study found that when families receive secure land rights, they start more businesses and obtain more credit, and the poor gain the most (Manysheva, 2022).

Even a poor family that does not start a business will be able to grow fruit, meat and vegetables for itself on the smallholding, and use the money saved to get ahead economically.

What the plan does not ask for

- **No ruling on ownership claims.** All village residents are entitled to the solution the plan offers, with or without a claim. No one gives up their legal position – neither the residents nor the state. Insisting on resolving the claims as a condition for regularization means non-recognition in practice, and should therefore be abandoned.
- **No land from Jewish communities.** Most of the area is regional (unassigned) land. Only at the margins will small areas be transferred from Arad, Yeruham and Tamar, where Bedouin villages already stand today.
- **No lawlessness.** During the interim period, clear rules will set out what is permitted and what is forbidden, and anyone who breaches them will be subject to

> enforcement. When every family has a legal place to build, enforcement becomes easy and cheap.

7. From Day One to the Next Generation

The strategic decision is what matters most: once the government makes a historic decision to change course, it will be possible to stop demolishing and start building and developing. The change in atmosphere will be swift and dramatic: an easing of years of tension and mistrust, and the opening of a new era in the Negev.

Emergency and interim period. Implementing the plan in full will take time, but many communities face demolition now. Therefore, from the day the government is formed, demolitions will stop; within 14 days, fines and other punitive measures designed to pressure residents will be cancelled, and measures that contradict regularization will be frozen. At the same time, clear rules will be set for the interim period: what may be built until the planning is approved, and what is subject to enforcement. Full details are in the Implementation Annex.

Macro: functioning councils. Expanding the Bedouin councils to about 600,000 dunams will leave them with about 4 dunams per capita, against 28 in the Jewish councils. This is not a takeover of the Negev; it narrows the gap from 56-fold to sevenfold. Advanced agriculture, renewable energy, employment zones, commercial roads, a higher-education institution and other ventures will be promoted in the open areas, bringing the councils tens of millions of shekels in municipal property tax (arnona). The Bnei Shimon logistics center alone is valued at about 35 million shekels a year (Neve Midbar Strategic Plan, 2024). The Planning Administration already designates some 278,000 dunams for agriculture in the area, 90% of it Bedouin (Eastern Negev Regional Plan, draft, April 2026). The land exists.

Micro: a smallholding for every family. 150,000 dunams will be divided into 30,000 homesteads of 5 dunams: 2 for housing and 3 for livelihood, not necessarily adjacent. On the residential plots, building will rise upward over the years and will suffice for at least two generations: parents, their children and some of the grandchildren.

Agricultural and other businesses will be set up on the smallholdings. Half the fields that feed Israel are abroad: it farms about 4.2 million dunams, and a similar area is cultivated for it overseas. Farmland per capita is expected to shrink by almost half by 2050, and the Planning Administration itself designates the south as the country's agricultural reserve (Strategic Plan 2040). Local greenhouses, orchards and flocks will strengthen food security and lower the cost of living. Agrivoltaic installations, tourism sites, garages, metal workshops and more will also be set up. Making land accessible as a means of production is an effective way to advance a population with high levels of poverty economically.

At the same time, the structure of governance will change. The Bedouin Authority will be closed in its current form, and its powers, including local planning, will pass to the government ministries and the councils – as everywhere else in the country.

8. Conclusion

For six decades the state has tried, without success, to move the villages. Enormous damage has been done along the way. The Councils Plan proposes a change of approach: to see the land as an engine of growth rather than a battlefield, and the village residents as an opportunity for prosperity rather than a problem.

The current reality is the result of wrong decisions, not fate. It can still be put right. The decision lies with the next government.

The Regional Councils Plan – Implementation Annex

This annex sets out the steps, deadlines and responsible bodies for implementing the Regional Councils Plan. It is intended to assist in drafting clauses of a coalition agreement and government decisions.

Deadlines are counted from the day the government is formed, unless otherwise stated. Values in square brackets are proposals for consideration in negotiations.

A. Principles of the "Regional Councils Plan"

1. The government will work toward a comprehensive, agreed and sustainable permanent arrangement for Bedouin settlement in the Negev, regularizing the villages and communities where they stand – and, in exceptional cases, at a nearby location – all subject to the law.
2. Regularization will rest on three complementary pillars:
   - An emergency and interim-period program, until regularization is complete;
   - Spatial and municipal regularization (macro): expanding the Bedouin regional councils and including the villages in a contiguous, planned municipal space;
   - Family-level regularization (micro): a family smallholding as the basic unit for housing, inter-generational growth and economic activity.
3. Eligibility for a smallholding will be granted to all village residents, both those with ownership claims and those without. Regularization will not be conditional on ruling on ownership claims or on waiving them, and will not detract from the position of any party.
4. The land for expanding the councils will come mostly from regional (unassigned) areas. Transfer of land from neighboring authorities will be limited to the margins where Bedouin villages stand.
5. During the interim period, clear rules for housing and building will be set under the "Life Now" program, and breaching them will be subject to enforcement. Once planning is approved, new construction will take place only in accordance with the approved plans.
6. The land, development and infrastructure costs imposed on families will be set so as to be affordable, and will not be a barrier to regularization.

B. Implementation Mechanism

1. **Socio-economic study.** On the day it is formed, or within 14 days, the government will decide on an independent study to measure, as precisely as possible, the economic (nominal) and social benefits of full implementation of the plan.
   - The study will examine, among other things, the benefits of improved early-childhood education; solving the housing problem; higher educational attainment and lower dropout rates; women's employment; bringing "idle" young people (NEET) into work; projected small and medium-sized businesses on the smallholdings; the economic potential of industrial zones and commercial roads; agriculture and energy; reduced

crime; savings on enforcement, transportation and welfare payments; local authority revenues; increased purchasing power in the Negev; and any other relevant item at the researchers' discretion.

- In the same decision the government will determine the body that will carry out the study: the Chief Economist Department at the Ministry of Finance, the Bank of Israel Research Department, or another relevant body.
- Preliminary findings, based on existing data and precedents, will be submitted within 30 days. The full report will be submitted within 60 days.
- The findings will strengthen the implementation process and provide insight into its priorities and methods. They will be used to set measurable targets for the work plan, as was done in Five-Year Plan 550.

2. **Ministerial committee.** On the day the government is formed, or within 14 days, a dedicated ministerial committee for regularizing Bedouin settlement in the Negev will be established, chaired by the minister responsible for the Division for the Socio-Economic Development of Bedouin Society in the Negev.
3. **Decision of principle.** On the day it is formed, or within 14 days, the government will adopt a decision of principle changing the regularization policy: instead of concentration and urbanization, recognition of the villages where they stand, on the model of a moshav ovdim (workers' cooperative village) or a similar model, with a residential plot and a smallholding for every family (Chapter F). Only in exceptional cases where there is no alternative will a village be regularized on the same model at a suitable nearby location. The decision will also determine the responsible bodies, the implementation mechanism and the timelines. In the same decision the government will instruct the Minister of the Interior to carry out staff work on the council boundaries (section E1) and will decide on the residents' census (section F5).
4. **Implementation team.** Within 30 days the ministerial committee will set up an inter-ministerial implementation team headed by a senior figure from Bedouin society [to be determined in negotiations], with the participation of government ministries, local authorities and representatives of the communities and representative organizations. The team will serve as the professional arm of the ministerial committee: it will prepare the work plan, coordinate among ministries and monitor execution. On the day it is set up, the team will be tasked with formulating the "Life Now" program (section C4).
5. **Work plan.** Within 90 days the ministerial committee will submit to the government a multi-year work plan, including: timelines for recognition and regularization; boundary-change procedures; detailed planning of the villages and smallholdings; the pilot programs – that is, the first villages where recognition will begin immediately on the basis of existing plans (sections D3 and E3) – and a timeline for completing them; infrastructure and development; a detailed program for strengthening the regional councils (section G2); division of responsibility among ministries; a multi-year budget and funding sources; measurable milestones; and recommendations on the frozen plans (section C3).
6. **Budget.** The resources required for implementation will be allocated within the state budget.

7. **Reporting.** Once a quarter, the ministerial committee will report to the government on the progress of implementation and on whether government ministries are meeting their targets.

C. Emergency and Interim-Period Program

C1 Halting Demolitions and Displacement

From the day the government is formed until permanent arrangements are in place:

1. Home demolitions and the execution of "removal" (eviction) orders to remove residents from the land on which they live will stop immediately, in the villages and communities included in the regularization process.
2. Administrative and legal proceedings aimed at demolishing structures or evicting and uprooting communities from their land will be frozen.
3. The government will advance the legislative amendments, regulations and decisions required to freeze enforcement proceedings during the interim period.

C2 Fines, Charges and Entitlements

On the day the government is formed, or within 14 days:

1. Fines imposed under Amendment 116 to the Planning and Building Law (the "Kaminitz Law") that have not yet been collected will be cancelled.
2. The government will act to settle or cancel other charges imposed in connection with home demolitions, in accordance with a legal arrangement to be determined.
3. Revoked entitlements to regularization grants will be restored, and Israel Land Council decisions that harmed eligibility for plots will be re-examined.

C3 Freezing Measures That Contradict Regularization

On the day it is formed, or within 14 days, the government will:

1. Freeze the "Mikudim" (focal points) plan, the "Yishur Kav" (alignment) reform, the "Caravans Plan" and any other plan that contradicts the principles of the Regional Councils Plan, until the multi-year work plan is submitted (section B5). The implementation team will examine their status and their conflict with the Councils Plan, and will include in the work plan recommendations on whether to cancel or amend them.
2. Freeze implementation of Government Decisions 1325 and 3811, on establishing new communities along Route 25 and in the Arad Valley, insofar as it contradicts implementation of the plan, until they are amended. No regional council will be established for these communities before the decision on the boundaries of the Bedouin councils is made (Chapter E).
3. Stop "land-protection" afforestation on land used for farming or housing.
4. Cancel the policy of "enforcement in support of regularization" set in Government Decision 2397 of 2017. Enforcement will be applied only under the law, where it is justified on its merits, and not as a means of pressure to secure consent to regularization, concentration or eviction.

C4 The "Life Now" Program

The implementation team will begin formulating "Life Now" on the day it is set up (section B4), and the rules will be approved within 90 days of the government's formation. "Life Now" is a set of rules for the interim period, until the planning is approved and building with permits under planning law becomes possible. It will allow reasonable living conditions and development in the villages, and will include, among other things:

1. Rules for housing and for needs arising from natural growth during the interim period. For example, a young couple will be able to build next to the parents' home within limits to be set, and breaching them will be subject to enforcement;
2. Solutions for families whose homes have been demolished in recent years;
3. Solutions for young couples and new households;
4. Temporary rules for keeping livestock and herds until regularization: pens, sheds and fodder stores within limits to be set, and temporary grazing arrangements;
5. Solutions for developing the local economy already during the interim period: temporary permits for small businesses, commerce and crafts in the villages, and access to government support programs for businesses and farmers;
6. Provision of essential services and infrastructure that cannot wait for statutory planning to be completed: water, electricity, service centers, kindergartens and clinics.

C5 Protection (Shelter) Solutions

Within 30 days, the Home Front Command will be instructed to draw up a specification for household protection in the unrecognized villages: a protective shelter that families can install themselves and at their own expense, bury in the ground, and remove and relocate after regularization. At the same time, a temporary provision will be advanced allowing the shelters to be installed without a building permit and regardless of land designation, subject to professional specifications, Home Front Command guidelines and safety requirements.

C6 Education

The government will not advance the establishment of a separate education authority for Bedouin society. State responsibility for the education system will remain with the Ministry of Education.

D. Communities Requiring an Immediate Response

The implementation team will address these communities as its first task, without waiting for the overall process to be completed, and will bring to the government for approval, within 120 days of its formation, a decision establishing solutions for communities facing eviction, demolition or planning proceedings that require an immediate response, in dialogue with the residents.

D1 Villages in a State of Emergency and Villages With Ready Plans

Community	Required response
Al-Baqi'a and Umm al-Badun	Advance recognition according to the plan of the residents and the Bimkom association, at a location near Arad. Alternative: Al-Baqi'a near Arad, and Umm al-Badun as a tourist village on the descent from Arad to the Dead Sea.
Tel Arad	Advance recognition according to the plan prepared with the residents and Bimkom, and adapt the "Mevo'ot Arad" plan
Nahal Hava and Nahal Arikha	Advance recognition according to the plan of the residents and the Keshet association (see also section D3)
Ras Jrabah	Integrate the village as a rural neighborhood of Dimona, with an interim solution until development is completed
Al-Fukhari	Freeze the displacement from the Lehavim area and formulate an agreed solution: a neighborhood in Lehavim or a village in the area
Karkur	Regularization at a location to be agreed, as part of Rahat or separately from it, based on the plan Bimkom prepared with the residents
Mishor Rotem	An agreed solution for the Abu al-Misk and al-Waj families, who were harmed by demolitions
Umm Rataam	Advance regularization in place according to the principles of the Councils Plan
Abda, Rakhma, Hashem a-Zaneh	Adapt the planning to the principles of the Regional Councils Plan. See also section D3

D2 Communities That Were Demolished or Evicted

Community	Required response
Dhahiya	50 homes demolished on 12.10.2026. Immediate temporary housing, and a permanent solution according to the principles of the Councils Plan.
Abu Qrenat (Umm Mitnan)	A solution for the Abu Hlayel and al-Na'ami families
Wadi al-Khalil	Complete the solution for the Abu Assa family
Umm al-Hiran	Complete the solution for the village's displaced residents
As-Sirr	A temporary housing solution until the new neighborhood in Segev Shalom is developed, and restoration of revoked entitlements
Al-Araqib	A solution in line with the residents' wishes
Other communities and neighborhoods that were completely demolished	Swift solutions also for communities and neighborhoods not listed here

D3 The First Package of Decisions: Within 60 Days

Within 60 days, the ministerial committee and the implementation team will bring the following decisions to the government for approval:

1. **Abda, Rakhma, Hashem a-Zaneh and the tourism nodes.** Amend Government Decisions 579 and 1362 and advance an amendment to District Master Plan 14/4, Change 89, so as to cancel the conditions that make the recognition, planning, development, granting of a locality code or occupancy of the three communities dependent on reaching a minimum rate of consent to relocation (sections E–F of Decision 579 and section F of Decision 1362). The communities in the tourism nodes – Nahal Hava, Nahal Arikha and Ramat Tziporim – will be regularized where they stand (in Nahal Hava and Nahal Arikha, according to the plan of the residents and the Keshet association) as outlying neighborhoods of Abda, will be attached to it for planning and local-government purposes, and permanent residence will be permitted in them. Their residents will not be regarded as a population designated for eviction or relocation.
2. **Mevo'ot Arad.** Amend the decision on establishing the Mevo'ot Arad communities so that it allows Tel Arad to be recognized where it stands.
3. **Advancing existing plans.** The government will instruct the Planning Administration to immediately advance the plans already prepared with the residents, according to the principles set out in them: Nahal Hava and Nahal Arikha (Keshet); Tel Arad, Al-Baqi'a and Umm al-Badun, and Karkur (Bimkom). Where lacking, the plans will be updated so that every eligible family receives 2 dunams for housing and 3 dunams for business development, not necessarily adjacent.

D4 Villages for the Next Stage

The following villages will be addressed within the framework of village planning (section F5), and not in the immediate decision:

Community	Required response
Wadi al-Na'am and al-Grin	Update the planning and adapt it to the principles of the Councils Plan
Al-Sira	Advance regularization in place according to the principles of the Councils Plan
Bir Hadaj, Abu Tulul, Abu Qrenat, Qasr al-Sir, Umm Batin, Al-Sayyid, Makhul, Kukhleh, Drijat, Sawe, Al-Fur'a	Adapt the plans, accelerate development and complete recognition according to the principles of the Councils Plan
Tarabin al-Sana	Transfer municipal responsibility from Al-Kasom to the Bnei Shimon Regional Council, which surrounds the community and is close to it, to improve services for residents

E. The Macro Solution: The Regional Councils

E1 Expanding the Municipal Space

On the day it is formed, or within 14 days, the government will task the Minister of the Interior with advancing staff work to expand the jurisdiction of the Neve Midbar and Al-Kasom regional councils so that they encompass all the villages in the regional (unassigned) area and its surroundings, and to establish a regional council in the Beersheba Valley. The Director-General of the Ministry of the Interior will appoint a boundaries committee, which will examine the change, hear the authorities and bodies concerned, and submit its recommendations within 90 days, together with a detailed plan for establishing the Valley council (section E3). Within 120 days the government will adopt a detailed decision on expanding the councils and establishing the Valley council, together with the decision on land allocation (section F1), and the Minister of the Interior will act to implement it in accordance with the law.

In all, this is an area of about 600,000 dunams, compared with about 71,000 today. It will include 39 of the 46 villages, subject to planning and boundary-change procedures. The land will come mostly from regional (unassigned) areas. Transfer of land from Arad, Yeruham and the Tamar Regional Council will be limited to the margins where Bedouin villages stand.

E2 Municipal Contiguity

The boundary change will be planned so as to reduce unassigned areas between the villages and create contiguous municipal spaces that allow: joint regional planning; infrastructure development; provision of municipal services; development of the authorities' own sources of revenue; and allocation of land for housing, employment, agriculture, commerce and regional services.

E3 The Beersheba Valley Regional Council: A Pilot Program

1. As a first stage of implementation, the government will advance the establishment of the Beersheba Valley Regional Council, for some 30,000 residents, in six villages: Al-Zarnug, Bir al-Mashash, Bir al-Hamam, Al-Ghara, Arwais and Khirbet al-Watan.
2. The government will establish the council's institutions, including a local planning and building committee, and will advance the recognition and development of the six villages.
3. A detailed plan for establishing the council (proposed boundaries, division of powers, budget sources and timeline) will be submitted to the government within 90 days, together with the recommendations of the boundaries committee (section E1).

E4 Developing the Open Areas

Within the regional planning, land will be designated, among other things, for:

1. Advanced agriculture, with an indicative scope of 200,000–300,000 dunams;
2. Renewable-energy installations, with an indicative scope of about 50,000 dunams, to generate 5,000 megawatts;
3. Industrial, crafts, commercial and employment zones;
4. Institutions of higher education, vocational training and Hebrew-language studies;

5. Commercial and employment corridors along main roads;
6. Public transportation that enters the villages, and educational institutions in every village.

F. The Micro Solution: The Family Smallholding

F1 Land Allocation

Within 120 days, together with the decision on the council boundaries (section E1), the government will adopt a decision on allocating and planning some 150,000 dunams for housing and smallholdings, or the scope determined in the staff work:

Component	Per household	Total (30,000 households)
Residential plot	2 dunams	60,000 dunams
Smallholding for livelihood	3 dunams	90,000 dunams
Total	5 dunams	150,000 dunams

The allocation will apply to villages within the expanded councils: villages not within any municipal authority, villages that were recognized but not regularized, and the "internal dispersion" within recognized localities.

F2 Inter-Generational Housing

The planning will allow up to three multi-story residential buildings to be built on the residential plot over the years, to provide for at least two generations while preserving the rural character.

F3 Economic Activity

1. A range of economic uses will be permitted on the smallholding: poultry coops, sheep pens, greenhouses, agrivoltaic installations, tourism sites, crafts and small businesses.
2. Land for livelihood will be used under an economic-use contract with the state, which allows use of the land without a requirement to lease it.

F4 Resident Participation

1. The state will fund community advisers to accompany residents through planning and occupancy, through a body acceptable to the residents.

F5 Village Planning

1. **Census.** On the day it is formed, or within 14 days, the government will decide on a census of residents in the villages and the internal dispersion, to obtain a full picture of the number of residents and households in need of regularization. The census will be carried out by the Central Bureau of Statistics together with residents' committees in each village. Registration will be completed within 90 days, and the final lists within 120 days. The census will be conducted as follows:

- **Self-registration:** a call will be issued for all households to register, online or at registration points to be set up in the villages and regional councils, at convenient hours and with Arabic-speaking staff.
- **Mobile team:** a team will visit the homes of those unable to reach the registration points, including the elderly, people with disabilities and remote villages.
- **Mapping and verification:** registration will be cross-checked against the Population Registry, National Insurance Institute and Ministry of Education data, and against aerial mapping of structures, to prevent double registration and to identify missing households.
- **Transparency and objections:** the lists will be displayed in each village for 30 days. During this period any resident may object to them, and the residents' committee will help resolve disputes.
- **Data protection:** the information will be used for regularization and planning only, and not for enforcement.

2. **Plans.** Planning will begin in all villages in the first year. Within 18 months, development and regularization plans for 25 villages will be submitted for deposit, and within 30 months for all the rest, including villages recognized in the past that have not yet been developed.
3. **Regularization in place.** The smallholdings will be planned at existing places of residence, with exceptions, and as far as possible according to the traditional division of land among families.
4. **Removing barriers.** The government will amend or cancel decisions and master plans that prevent or restrict planning of the villages according to the plan's principles.
5. **Public areas.** Public buildings and infrastructure will be planned on state land wherever possible. Anyone who sets aside land in their possession for public purposes will be compensated with alternative land close to the village, for agriculture and economic development.
6. **Planning priority.** In any neighborhood or cluster where a majority of residents request, by signature, planning and development according to the principles of the Councils Plan, the planning will receive priority and will be conducted with public participation. This is not a condition for recognizing the village, nor a requirement to relocate.

G. Changing the Structure of Governance

G1 The Bedouin Authority

1. The government will set a date for ending the activity of the Authority for the Development and Settlement of the Bedouin in the Negev in its current form.
2. Within 180 days, a work plan will be drawn up for transferring powers, budgets, personnel and executive responsibility from the Authority to the relevant government ministries and to the local and regional authorities.
3. The transfer of powers will be carried out in stages and according to milestones, in a manner that prevents disruption to the continuity of services to residents.

G2 Strengthening the Bedouin Authorities

1. The multi-year work plan (section B5) will include a draft program for strengthening the regional councils and preparing them to provide full municipal services within their expanded boundaries. The implementation team will complete the detailed program within 120 days of the government's formation.
2. Within 120 days, adjustments will be proposed to the existing district committee for Al-Kasom and Neve Midbar (the Abu Basma District Committee), to fit in with the plan's other measures.
3. Within 24 months, full planning powers will be transferred from the Bedouin Authority and the Abu Basma District Committee to the regional councils.

H. Timeline

Deadline	What happens	Section
Day the government is formed	Halt to demolitions and to the execution of removal orders; freeze on demolition and eviction proceedings	C1
Within 14 days	Ministerial committee established; decision of principle: recognition of villages where they stand on the moshav model; decision on the socio-economic study; cancellation of uncollected fines and restoration of rights to regularization grants; freeze on contradictory plans; halt to afforestation; cancellation of "enforcement in support of regularization"; education remains with the Ministry of Education; Interior Minister instructed to carry out staff work on council boundaries; decision on the residents' census	B1–B3, C2–C3, C6, E1, F5
30 days	Implementation team set up and work on "Life Now" begins; preliminary study findings; shelter specification and temporary provision	B1, B4, C4, C5
60 days	Full study report; first package of decisions: Abda, Rakhma, Hashem a-Zaneh and the tourism nodes (including Nahal Hava and Nahal Arikha); Mevo'ot Arad; advancing existing plans	B1, D3
90 days	Multi-year work plan, including draft for strengthening the councils; approval of "Life Now" rules; boundaries committee recommendations and detailed plan for the Valley council; census registration completed	B5, C4, E1, E3, F5, G2
120 days	Detailed decision on council areas, establishment of the Valley council and allocation of land for housing and economic use; decision on communities requiring an immediate response; final census lists; detailed program for strengthening the councils; adjustments to the Abu Basma District Committee	D, E1, F1, F5, G2
180 days	Plan for transferring the Bedouin Authority's powers	G1

Deadline	What happens	Section
18 months	Plans for the first 25 villages submitted for deposit	F5
24 months	Full planning powers transferred to the regional councils	G2
30 months	Plans for the remaining villages submitted for deposit	F5
Every quarter	Report to the government	B7

I. Decisions and Documents the Plan Draws On

- Government Decision 2491 (2007): establishment of the Goldberg Committee to formulate a feasible plan for regularizing Bedouin settlement.
- Goldberg Committee report (2008): recommendation "to recognize the villages as far as possible".
- Government Decision 4411 (2009): a policy that takes into account the needs of the Bedouin population and can be implemented within a short period.
- Government Decision 3707 (2011) and Government Decision 5345 (2013): accelerated regularization within a limited, defined period.
- Strategic plan prepared for the Bedouin Authority (2014): "The Dispersed Locality".
- Bedouin Authority letter (9.2.2022): "to provide solutions as close as possible to the residents' place of residence", and examination of new communities in the Beersheba Valley.
- Knesset Research and Information Center, data summary on the Bedouin Authority (June 2024).
- INSS, lessons from Five-Year Plans 922 and 550 (2022): setting defined indicators and targets as a condition for implementation.
- Eastern Negev Regional Plan, Planning Administration (Plan 607-1584267, draft, April 2026).
- Neve Midbar Regional Council Strategic Plan (2024).